

iPhone. They claim it to be six times faster than Safari. The only problem relating to resizing of web pages due to the pinch gestures will be rectified in the later updates of the browser.

BlackBerry to have Push notifications

The push notification in BlackBerry phones which was available to only a select few developers is now open to all. This technology allows apps to notify users of any new development in real time. Due to this, the phone does not have to constantly poll the server looking for data, which results in saving battery life. RIM is offering two levels of Push Services i.e. Push Essentials which is free and Push Plus which has a tiered pricing model which will allow developers more content delivery options.

This functionality will prove very helpful for application developers developing for areas that are constantly updated like news, sports, weather, stock prices and other related items. For social networking sites like Twitter and Facebook this is paramount. BlackBerry Push Service software development kit provided to app developers will allow them to implement the push functionality in their apps. Options like point-to-point, multicast or broadcast can be selected based on the need of the app.

Prior to this development, the BlackBerry used a mechanism called polling, where the application actively checked for data. Polling may or may not return new data but it does take a toll on battery life. With BlackBerry push notifications, the applications will not have to check for any data, instead they will receive a notification in real time in case of updates. After

receiving the data, the application can then decide how it wants to process it.

With competitors like Apple and Android, it was only logical for BlackBerry to open up such functionalities to application developers. Only time will tell if this move will spell success for BlackBerry.

Tegra 2 shows up in India

NVIDIA recently unveiled the next generation of their mobile platform Tegra in India. Tegra was designed primarily as a low-power device to handle high-definition content. With the rebirth of tablets, and the demand for processing power for media content and applications, the Tegra 2xx series seems to fit the gap.



The Tegra 2 chip

The Tegra 250 is made up of multiple processors, each designed to handle HD video, audio and images. 1080p videos can run easily, and support for Flash 10.1 is also present. Long battery life is also one of the promises.

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Two prototypes were displayed at the event, each running Android OS on 7-inch 800x480 touchscreens. One of the companies was developed by Compal and the other

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by EAFT, an Indian company that focuses on entertainment and educational purposes. The EAFT MagicTile has been designed with icons so the interface remains language agnostic. The Notion Ink ADAM wasn't part of the event, but it also uses the Tegra 250 platform.



ices, Etisalat, S Tel, Videocon, Reliance Communications, Idea Cellular and Aircel. BSNL and MTNL, the two state run telecommunication companies already have 3G licenses.

These 3G licenses are expected to cover 22 of the 24 wireless zones across India.

Watch a hands on video of MagicTile at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/tegra2/>

The interesting thing here is the power available to products of these kinds. With lots of Android based tablets coming out and NVIDIA Tegra 2 there to power them, the iPad could face some serious competition. In most tablets, the Tegra 250 is coupled with the dual-core ARM A9 Cortex processor; the Apple iPad uses the single-core Cortex8. Tegra isn't going to be limited to tablets either. With phones, portable media players and HD media players all in queue, NVIDIA's Tegra will pervade the market.

3G Auctions in April

India's Department of Telecommunication (DoT) will conduct auctions from 3G spectrum on April 9th and two days after

Spectrum will be allotted to three top bidders in 17 circles, while five circles will have four players, excluding state-run BSNL and MTNL. The base price for the all-India spectrum has been fixed at around Rs. 3,500 crores.

As for the wireless broadband around eleven bidders have shown interest namely Tikona Digital, Qualcomm, Tata Communications, Vodafone-Essar, Idea Cellular, Bharti Airtel, Aircel, Spice, Augere, HFCL, and Reliance Communications. Air waves for broadband services will be allocated to two operators in all circles. The base price for the BWA spectrum has been set at Rs. 1,750 crores.

Operators who win the bid will have to pay the entire amount within ten days, although they can commence services only by September 1.

3G auctions have been talked about in the past as well and 3G auctions have been delayed thrice since January 2009 times over disagreements pertaining to the base price, number of licenses sold and bandwidth availability. We sincerely hope that this time around the 3G auctions do take place. **d**